

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ K 9 5 2

♥ 9

♦ K Q J 9

♣ Q J 7 5

♠ 6 3

♥ A J 10

♦ A 6 3

♣ A 9 8 4 2



♠ A J 10 8 4

♥ 4 3

♦ 10 7 4

♣ K 10 3

♠ Q 7

♥ K Q 8 7 6 5 2

♦ 8 5 2

♣ 6

West

North

East

South

Pass

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by South

Lead: ♦ K

3♥

Win the ♦ A, play ♣ A and ruff the ♣ 2 with a high trump. Play a ♥ to the ♥ 10 and ruff the ♣ 4 with a high trump. Play a ♥ to the ♥ J and ruff the ♣ 8 with a high trump. Play a ♥ to the ♥ A and discard a loser on the good ♣ 9.

It took a 4-3 ♣ split to make this contract.

Fortunately that occurs a high percentage of the time. In any case, there was no other hope.

Responding to preempts is easy. You don't count points, you just count tricks. Assume partner for 6 tricks and add yours to see how high to go (or not go).

Here, with three Aces and a possible ♠ ruff you raise to game.

North would play 4♥.

Click

South plays 4♥. East leads the ♦ K.

Things look grim. The defense has exposed your ♦ losers already and those two ♠ losers seem pretty obvious also. If you are to make this contract you must do so before you lose the lead. That means you must establish the ♣ suit **NOW**.

Board 2
 South Deals
 None Vul

♠ Q 9 7 3
 ♥ J 7 2
 ♦ 9 6 5
 ♣ 8 6 2

♠ K 8 6

♥ A 8 4

♦ A Q 8

♣ Q J 10 7

N
 W E
 S

♠ A 4 2

♥ 10 9 5 3

♦ 7 4 2

♣ 5 4 3

♠ J 10 5

♥ K Q 6

♦ K J 10 3

♣ A K 9

You have 16 points - a pretty solid 16 in fact. Partner has 15, 16 or 17, so together you have 31, 32 or 33. You want to invite partner to bid 6NT if he has 17, but to decline if he has 15. The correct bid for this invitation is 4NT. It is called a "quantitative" 4NT since it is just an invitational raise. It is **NOT** Blackwood - if you wanted to ask for Aces you would use Gerber.

Partner bids the slam.

North would play 6NT.

West	North	East	South
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Pass	4NT	Pass	1NT
All Pass			6NT

6NT by South

Lead: ♠ 3

Winner count: ♠ 0 : ♥ 3 : ♦ 4 : ♣ 4 : Total = 11

Click

South plays 6NT. West leads the ♠ 3.

South plays 6NT. West leads the ♠ 3.

It's pretty clear which suit you have to worry about! Your goal is simple, you must win one ♠ trick before you lose two. So the crux of your problem is: Who holds the ♠ A and ♠ Q?

If West has both of them you are guaranteed to win the first trick no matter what you play.

If East has both of them you are going to lose the first two tricks no matter what you play.

The problem is to decide what to do if they are split. The answer relies on psychology, not on probability. West has made an attacking lead. But if you were West would you start out leading a low ♠ from a suit like ♠ A 9 7 3? That would be incredibly foolhardy, you would probably lead a different suit and save your ♠ A for catching something high from declarer. On the other hand you would be quite likely to lead a small card from ♠ Q 9 7 3.

Your PLAN should be to play low in dummy and win your ♠ 10 if East withholds the ♠ A.

If you think West has ♠ A 9 7 3 then you should play the ♠ K from dummy. But if you think West has ♠ Q 9 7 3 you should play low from dummy.

Since West is unlikely to underlead an Ace against 6NT you play East for the ♠ A.

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ K 9 7 3

♥ 8 3 2

♦ J 4

♣ Q J 10 4

♠ Q J 5

♥ K 5 4

♦ 10 9 7 3

♣ 8 6 2



♠ 10 8 6 2

♥ 9

♦ K Q 8 6

♣ K 7 5 3

♠ A 4

♥ A Q J 10 7 6

♦ A 5 2

♣ A 9

West

North

East

South

Pass

2♥

Pass

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by South

Lead: ♣Q

Well, you are **SUPPOSED** to have plenty of points for game. So why isn't it laydown? Answer: Because North has ♠ Q J instead of ♠ K. If he had ♠ K it would be a laydown.

So all you have to do is turn the ♠ Q J into the equivalent of the ♠ K. It's easy.

Win the ♣A. Take two rounds of trumps with the ♥A Q. East shows out on the second trump lead. Play the ♠A, then the ♠4. West will win the ♠K and the defense will take their ♣ trick. Then they must give you the lead and you play a ♥ to dummy's ♥K, pulling West's final trump. Play the good ♠Q, discarding one of your ♦ losers.

Admittedly it would have been simpler if North held the ♠K.

With the ♠ Q J instead you just have to take care with entries. (Make that entry, singular.)

You are very close to the 22 points needed to open 2♣.

Of course close only counts in horse-shoes and hand grenades. So you open 1♥.

Partner responds 2♥.

This is a no-brainer. With partner showing 6-10 points you have plenty enough for game.

So you bid 4♥.

South plays 4♥. West leads the ♣Q.

South plays 4♥. West leads the ♣Q.

Losers: ♠ 1 : ♥ 0 : ♦ 2 : ♣ 1 : Total = 4

Board 4

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 5
♥ K 10 4
♦ J 9 4 2
♣ J 10 9 3 2

♠ K Q J 2

♥ 8 5 3

♦ K 7

♣ A 8 7 4



♠ 8 6 4

♥ A J 9 2

♦ Q 10 3

♣ K 6 5

♠ A 10 9 7 3

♥ Q 7 6

♦ A 8 6 5

♣ Q

West	North	East	South
			1 ♠
Pass	2 ♣	Pass	2 ♦
Pass	4 ♠		
All Pass			
4 ♠ by South			

Lead: ♣J

ruff both ♦ losers in dummy. Or, you could ruff three ♣ losers in your hand, it would work out the same.

The first key is to go up with the ♣A. you cannot afford to lose a ♣ now with those three ♥ losers staring you in the face.

Next play the ♠K and ♠A, but West shows out on the second one. Don't pull a third one. You need to make those last five trumps separately. Take your two high ♦s, then start cross-ruffing ♣s and ♦s. You will lose the final three ♥s.

This is really a cross-ruff type plan.

And with any cross-ruff it is best to pull as many trumps as you can spare before you start ruffing. Leave yourself just the number of trumps you need.

You have a real bare-bones 13 points. No matter, you don't pass with 13. So you open 1 ♠.

Partner responds 2 ♣.

You have two choices - bid 2NT or bid 2 ♦. Neither is showing any extra strength so partner shouldn't go crazy. Not liking that singleton you say 2 ♦.

Partner goes crazy and bids 4 ♠.

South plays 4 ♠. West leads the ♣J.

South plays 4 ♠. West leads the ♣J.

Losers: ♠ 0 : ♥ 3 : ♦ 2 : ♣ 0 : Total = 5

You may think you're lucky they didn't take their ♥ tricks, but the truth is that they will probably get them anyway. If trumps split 2-2 then you can easily